

YVONNE LI

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Systems thinker and o□1 builder spanning architecture, real estate finance, IP product design, legal practice, and AI. I translate complex systems — legal frameworks, capital structures, brand logic — into tools and strategies that give people real leverage. Founded an original IP brand (\$350K ARR), built and shipped live AI products, managed \$25M+ institutional portfolios, and now run an AI-augmented legal and startup consulting practice. Targeting AI product management and product design roles where cross-domain thinking is a feature, not a footnote.

EXPERIENCE

NextStep Services

Los Angeles, CA

Founder & Principal · California Registered Legal Document Assistant (LDA)

Feb 2025 – Present

- Founded an AI-augmented consulting practice for international graduates navigating US immigration and company formation — combining legal document assistance with startup strategy.
- End-to-end client model: advise on visa pathway (H-1B, OPT STEM, EB alternatives), business entity formation, equity structure, and business plan development; operate as a California registered LDA.
- Built and shipped *H-1B Compass* (visa-vantage.lovable.app) — a live AI tool encoding H-1B filing logic into a self-serve strategy engine: SOC code matching, wage analysis, lottery odds, and ranked visa pathways.
- Deploy LLM workflows (Claude, GPT-4) for client research, market sizing, business plan analysis, and document preparation — compressing multi-hour analysis into actionable session outputs.

New Dream Services

Irvine, CA

Acquisition Manager

Oct 2023 – Dec 2024

- Conducted detailed appraisals of 7 major commercial real estate properties across the US using ARGUS Enterprise and Excel, identifying investment opportunities and simplifying financial complexity for stakeholders.
- Managed a \$25M+ portfolio, outperforming market benchmarks by 5.5% through strategic oversight and financial analysis.
- Prepared investment memoranda and presentations for stakeholders; coordinated acquisition efforts and property management with brokers to optimize profitability.

Financial and Investment Analyst

Aug 2022 – Oct 2023

- Developed financial models for 23 real estate projects, enhancing performance predictions using DCF and exit strategy analysis.
- Supported due diligence by reviewing leases, comps, zoning, and market research to ensure accurate valuations and risk assessments.
- Managed deal pipeline and projection models, tracking acquisitions and portfolio performance; coordinated financial reporting with external accountants.

CBRE

Los Angeles, CA

Financial Intern

Jun 2022 – Aug 2022

Investment Management

- Developed a \$1B M&A proposal for CBRE's expansion into Australia — incorporating economic analysis, valuations, and pro forma projections; recommended acquiring a local company to capitalize on undervalued post-pandemic assets.
- Conducted 50+ interviews with real estate professionals to synthesize qualitative industry intelligence into the strategic case.

Corporate Finance

- Enhanced recruiting financial models, boosting efficiency 20% through standardized global advisory commission structures.
- Built a 7+5 forecast and benefit realization model using Power BI; visualized and presented 9 benefit reports to senior management with efficiency recommendations.

US-Based Consumer Brand (*Confidential*)

Chino, CA

Brand Strategy Consultant

Aug 2022 – Jan 2023

- Repositioned the brand's Instagram identity from product-centric to lifestyle-aspirational — diagnosing the gap between existing content and target customer self-image, then rebuilding the full content strategy.
- Developed brand identity system: tone of voice, visual logic, content pillars, and narrative framework; rebuilt Instagram page aesthetic to attract quality-over-price buyers.
- Identified, vetted, and scripted video collaborations with aesthetically aligned creators to build brand premium in the North American market.

Cushman & Wakefield

Real Estate Consultant

Chengdu, China

Jan 2021 – Aug 2021

Valuation and Project Management

- Co-led a 7.5-acre multiuse development generating \$10M in revenue, overseeing concept to completion as part of a three-person team.
- Managed deliverables and coordinated with the due diligence team; synthesized findings into a 118-page client presentation.

Market Research and Due Diligence

- Performed 18 residential subdistrict interviews, 5 on-site investigations, and 30 consumer surveys for a Cultural Tourism development project.
- Participated in 7 real estate projects: government meetings, competitive bidding, and producing key decision-making research reports.

SPS Dolls

Founder & IP Designer

Multiple Cities, China

Oct 2019 – Jul 2021

- Founded an original BJD IP brand for young adult collectors, built around character depth and identity resonance; launched parallel children's sub-brand (1/6 scale) for market segmentation.
- Designed 15+ physical products across dolls, ceramics, resin casting, hand-blown glass eyes, and accessories; managed 5 factories across Dongguan and Yangzhou for end-to-end production.
- Built omnichannel distribution across Instagram, Etsy, and Weibo; ran KOL partnership campaigns, sponsored 4 national collector conventions, and grew brand to ~\$350K ARR.
- Represented affiliate wig, footwear, and apparel brands to extend product ecosystem; led 4-person team from inception through full commercial operation.

EDUCATION

Columbia University

M.S. Real Estate Finance

New York, NY

Aug 2020 – May 2022

Relevant: Real Estate Finance I–III, Fund Management, Market Analytics & Due Diligence, Financial Modeling, Real Estate Law, REITs, Urban Planning, Construction & Development, ARGUS Enterprise, Lease Negotiation, Affordable Housing

Washington University in St. Louis

B.S. Economics & Architecture (Double Major) · GPA 3.4/4.0

St. Louis, MO

Aug 2016 – May 2019

Relevant — Economics: Behavioral Economics, Econometrics, Capital Market Imperfections & Entrepreneurial Finance · Architecture: Core Design Studios, Building Systems, Digital Fabrication · Study Abroad: SRISA Florence — Encounters in Public Space, Jul–Aug 2018

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Product & AI: 0–1 product development · AI agent architecture · Prompt engineering · Interaction design · User research · Brand strategy · Storytelling & narrative

Technical: LLM integration (Claude, GPT-4, Gemini) · Power BI · ARGUS Enterprise · Figma · Adobe Creative Suite · Microsoft Office & Excel · Python (scripting) · Lovable · Cursor · GitHub

Analysis: Financial modeling (DCF, exit strategy) · Portfolio management · Market research · Due diligence · Primary research methodology

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native) · English (fluent)

Certifications: California LDA (Registered) · CFA Level I (Oct 2023) · ARGUS Enterprise (May 2022)